opportunity. At the Intelligence School, we also learnt to articulate ourselves with precision and logic, both orally and in writing.

It was also a great posting for me personally, as I met a very charming and talented young lady, Anupama, who was doing her graduation from Wadia College, Poona. We met at the New Year's dance, fell in love, and got married in May 1971. The circumstances under which we met were quite interesting, and made news when I became army chief. One media account went like this:

> *The scene was straight out of a movie. Across a crowded room, a young officer saw a beautiful girl escorted by her parents at a New Year's party at an army club. Most faces looked familiar as only members frequented the club. Only the girl stood out. The curiosity built and the brash captain entered a bet with his friend (Captain Ramesh Bhatia) that he would have a dance with her. The girl refused; and to drive home the message that she was not interested, she went and sat next to her mother to deter the young man. This is what they call an obstacle in military training. Being deft in negotiating obstacle courses, he walked up to the mother and asked her politely if he could have a dance with her pretty daughter. Faced with this impudence what could the poor mother do. And Captain Joginder Jaswant Singh had his first dance with petite Anupama, who became his wife in just a few months.*[1]

Anupama (whom I call Rohini), is also from an army family. Her father, Colonel Narenderpal Singh, was commanding the ordnance depot at Dehu Road, near Poona, at that time. Both her parents are also literary figures. Her mother, Prabhjot Kaur, is a famous poet who has been honoured with a Padma Shri. Her parents are also recipients of the Sahitya Akademi award for Punjabi literature, a rare achievement for a couple. Colonel Narenderpal Singh was commissioned in the Sikh Light Infantry during the Second World War, and served in the Middle East. Later, during the 1950s, he was transferred to the ordnance corps. Rohini soon realized that she had married a professional whose first love was the army. She once asked me what role she had as an army wife. My reply was, 'the soldiers will give their life for the nation on my orders so you must take care of their families first, and then look after our children and our home'.